

Case 5: DELETE — Remove a Resource

Send a DELETE request for post 1 and verify the server acknowledges the deletion.

API Endpoint

DELETE `https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com/posts/1`

What You Will Learn

- HTTP DELETE method
- Status code 200 OK on deletion
- Empty response body handling
- Negative testing concept (resource gone after delete)

Study Plan

Step 1 — Understand DELETE

DELETE removes a resource. The URL contains the resource id. No request body is needed.

Step 2 — Use `requests.delete()`

Call `requests.delete(url)` where `url` is `/posts/1`. No `json=` parameter needed.

Step 3 — Assert status 200

JSONPlaceholder returns 200 OK on successful deletion. Some APIs return 204 No Content instead — always check the docs.

Step 4 — Check the response body

After delete, JSONPlaceholder returns an empty JSON object `{}`. Assert `response.json() == {}`.

Step 5 — Think about negative testing

In a real API, a follow-up GET `/posts/1` would return 404. Think about how you would test that scenario as a bonus.

Your Task

Write a pytest test that sends a DELETE request to `/posts/1`.

The test must verify:

1. Status code is 200
2. The response body is an empty dict `{}`

BONUS: Describe (in a comment) how you would verify the post is truly gone.

Hint: `requests.delete(url)` — no body needed. `response.json()` should return `{}`.

Base URL: <https://jsonplaceholder.typicode.com> | No authentication required | Free public API